

Itauma Itauma, PhD, MBA

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Academic leader and analytics educator with experience in higher education administration, faculty mentorship, curriculum development, assessment, and student success initiatives. Proven ability to lead collaborative academic programs, support faculty development, and use data-informed decision-making to improve enrollment, retention, and program effectiveness. Experienced in strategic planning, interdisciplinary collaboration, inclusive pedagogy, and academic operations within graduate and undergraduate education. Recognized for nurturing a supportive learning environment, promoting faculty wellbeing, and integrating innovative instructional practices that enhance student engagement and institutional effectiveness.

Core Leadership Competencies

- Academic Leadership & Administration
- Faculty Mentorship & Evaluation
- Curriculum Development & Assessment
- Student Success & Retention Strategies
- Strategic Planning & Enrollment Management
- Inclusive Pedagogy & Universal Design for Learning
- Data-Informed Decision Making
- Program Review & Accreditation Support
- Cross-Functional Collaboration
- Organizational Leadership & Team Building
- Conflict Resolution & Student Support
- Learning Analytics & Educational Technology

Technical & Analytical Skills

Power BI, Tableau, SQL, Python, R, SAS, Excel, Data Visualization, Learning Analytics

Experience

Faculty/Division Chair/Assistant Professor of Analytics, 2020 – Present

Northwood University, Midland, MI

- Supported graduate programs serving diverse student populations across MBA, MSBA, and DBA programs.
- Collaborated with faculty and administrators on curriculum alignment, assessment planning, and program quality improvement initiatives.
- Mentor faculty and students in instructional innovation, applied research, and student-centered learning practices.
- Support strategic planning efforts through data-informed analysis of enrollment trends, student outcomes, and program performance.
- Facilitate curriculum review and program development aligned with institutional goals and workforce needs.
- Drive collaborative and inclusive learning environments that support belonging, engagement, and academic achievement.
- Mentored doctoral candidates through successful dissertation completion and conference presentations.
- Promote faculty collaboration, professional development, and well-being through relationship-centered leadership practices.
- Supported faculty mentorship, instructional guidance, and collaborative academic planning across graduate programs.
- Teach graduate and doctoral courses in analytics, AI, leadership, and business decision-making.
- Integrate Universal Design for Learning principles and applied learning strategies into course and program design.

Data Science Consultant, 2025

LearningMate, Remote

- Collaborated with interdisciplinary teams to develop data-informed digital learning solutions that enhanced learner engagement and instructional effectiveness.
- Supported development of AI-enabled educational tools and workflows aligned with student learning outcomes and organizational goals.

Faculty, Department of Computer Science, 2016 – 2020

Wayne State University, Detroit, MI

- Supported program assessment and continuous improvement initiatives aligned with institutional effectiveness goals.
- Participated in curriculum and assessment activities supporting academic quality and program alignment.

- Delivered instruction in data analytics, SQL, programming, and machine learning
- Guided student projects involving data analysis, database systems, and predictive modeling
- Conducted research using large datasets and high-performance computing for analytics applications

Faculty / Technical Program Facilitator, Data Analytics/Data Science, 2016 – 2019

Southern New Hampshire University, Remote

- Taught courses in data analytics, SQL, and business intelligence tools
- Supported development of data-driven decision-making skills using real-world datasets
- Contributed to curriculum aligned with industry analytics and BI practices

Graduate Teaching & Research Assistant, Department of Computer Science, 2013 – 2015

Wayne State University

- Conducted research utilizing high-performance computing cluster (HPCC) to solve big data problems, including image analysis using machine learning algorithms.
- Provided instruction and assessment support for computer science courses and laboratory sessions.

Academic Leadership Experience

- Division Chair, MSBA & DBA Programs, Northwood University
- Led curriculum coordination, faculty collaboration, and program assessment initiatives.
- Supported enrollment management, student retention, and continuous improvement efforts.
- Participated in academic planning, faculty mentorship, and cross-functional institutional initiatives.
- Supervised doctoral dissertation research and graduate student success initiatives.
- Collaborated with administration on strategic academic and operational goals.

Education

Data Science Fellow, 2025

University of Pennsylvania Center for Learning Analytics

Certificate in Data Science Methods for Digital Learning Platforms.

Program supported by the Institute of Education Sciences, U.S. Department of Education to the University of Pennsylvania.

Executive Master of Business Administration, 2025

Quantic School of Business and Technology

Focus Areas: Strategic Leadership, Organizational Management, Operations, Data-Driven Decision Making

Harvard Business Analytics Program, 2020

Harvard University

Executive Graduate Certificate in Business Analytics

- Relevant coursework: Digital Strategy, Quantitative Analysis, Leadership, Data Science Systems, Data-Driven Marketing

Ph.D. in Instructional Design and Technology, 2019

Keiser University

Dissertation: Pre-College Factors That Predict Intentions of Minority Females to Enroll in College STEM Programs

- Graduated with 4.0 GPA

Master of Science in Computer Science, 2015

Wayne State University

Focus: Big Data Analytics

Thesis: Unsupervised Learning and Image Classification in High-Performance Computing Clusters

Master of Science in Computer Engineering, 2012

Istanbul Technical University

Focus: Human-Robot Interaction

Thesis: Gesture Imitation Learning in Human-Robot Interaction

B.Eng in Electrical Engineering, 2004

University of Ilorin

Area of Concentration: Computer and Control Engineering

Thesis: Microprocessor Driven Traffic Light for a Dual Cross-Junction Road

Leadership & Collaboration

- Advocate for faculty wellbeing, collaborative leadership, and inclusive academic environments.
- Presented and facilitated discussions on teacher wellbeing, leadership, engagement, and AI in education at national conferences.
- Builds supportive learning communities that encourage belonging, professional growth, and interdisciplinary collaboration.

Community Engagement & Leadership

- Competitive pickleball coach and mentor focused on teamwork, strategic thinking, resilience, and community engagement.
- Developed structured instructional programs that promote confidence-building, collaboration, and inclusive participation across diverse learner groups.

Student Success & Teaching Philosophy

Committed to driving student success through inclusive pedagogy, mentorship, experiential learning, and data-informed academic support strategies. A collaborative and student-centered academic leader who uses analytics to support student success and institutional effectiveness.

Academic Service & Leadership

- Chair, AERA Annual Meeting (2026)
Session: Teacher Leadership, Wellbeing, and Retention
- Discussant, AERA Annual Meeting (2026)
Session: Preparing Future Educators in the Age of AI
- Moderator, 1st International Business Analytics Conference, Fredonia, NY (2024)
Track: Analytics in Business Education
- Dissertation Chair, DeVos Graduate School, Northwood University (2023–Present)

Dissertation Chairing & Supervision

DeVos Graduate School of Management, Northwood University

2023 – Present

- Supervised doctoral candidates from proposal through successful defense.
- Advised on methodology, statistical tools (SAS, R, SPSS), literature reviews, and compliance with academic standards.

Publications

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

Srikanth, S., & Itauma, I. (2026). Leveraging Generative AI as a Socio-Technical Mediator in Global Project Communication and Conflict Management. Paper accepted at the 3rd International Business Analytics Conference, Fredonia, NY.

Srikanth, S., & Itauma, I. (2025). Transforming Project Management through Data Analytics and Generative AI. *Empirical Economics Letters*, 24(September Special Issue 1), 93–109. <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.18866470>

Itauma O., Itauma I., 2024. AI Scribes: Boosting Physician Efficiency in Clinical Documentation. *International Journal on Bioinformatics & Biosciences*. 2024 Mar;14(1):09-18. 10.5121/ijbb.2024.14102.

Itauma O., Abara C., Gonullu D., Fee M., Itauma I., Awonuga A., 2020. Contraceptive choices by weight status among women in the United States: An analysis of the 2015-2017 National Survey of Family Growth. *Fertility and Sterility*, 114(3), pp.e173-e174.

Conference Proceedings & Presentations

Ravi, M., Yenuga, H., Itauma, I. (2025). Revolutionizing recruitment: Enhanced machine learning models for bias mitigation and efficiency. *Proceedings of the 2nd International Business Analytics Conference*, Fredonia, NY.

Rawat, P., Sharma, A., Itauma, I. (2025). Retaining value: Segment-based predictive models for customer churn in banking. *Proceedings of the 2nd International Business Analytics Conference*, Fredonia, NY. [Best Paper Award]

Itauma, I. (2024). Leveraging large language models for predictive analytics and code generation using ChatGPT and Gemini API. *Proceedings of the 1st International Business Analytics Conference*, Fredonia, NY.

Mutha, R., Itauma, I. (2024). Machine learning approaches for predicting wine quality from chemical properties in Azure Machine Learning Studio. Proceedings of the 1st International Business Analytics Conference, Fredonia, NY.

Nasim, M., Zhu, S., Itauma, I. (2024). An empirical analysis of the functionalities and confidence scoring mechanisms in leading large language models. Proceedings of the 1st International Business Analytics Conference, Fredonia, NY.

Itauma I., 2024. Technology Integration for Diverse Learners: Enhancing Engagement and Accessibility. Regional Center for Educational Planning (RCEP) UNESCO Symposium.

Itauma I., Robertson A., Fuda-Daddio J., Komaroff E., 2024. Factors Predicting Mathematics and Science Motivation among Minority Female High School Students. American Educational Research Association (AERA) 2024 Annual Meeting, Philadelphia, PA.

Omunguye D., Joshua Hopkins J., Guerrero A., Itauma I., 2023. Assessing ML Algorithms for VTE Risk Classification. Poster presented at the AI in Health Conference, Houston, TX

Renz J., Itauma I., Cutt K., 2020. COVID-19 Tracking App: An HBAP Coronal Project. Harvard Business Analytics Program.

Itauma I., 2020. Data Management & Analytics Simplified For The New Normal In The Health System. Hospital Data Management & Analytics Conference.

Itauma I., 2020. Engaging Students With Canvas in Online and Traditional Classrooms. Michigan Canvas Users Conference.

Messner A. and Itauma I., 2019: Exploring Co-Occurring Mental Illness and Substance Use Disorder Using HPCC Systems. Poster presented at the HPCC Systems Engineering Summit - Community Day.

Itauma I., 2018: Conducting Exploratory Data Analysis in Educational Research Using HPCC Systems. HPCC Systems Engineering Summit - Community Day.

Itauma O. and Itauma I., 2018: Cervical Cancer Risk Factors: Exploratory Analysis using HPCC Systems. HPCC Systems Engineering Summit - Community Day.

Walker C. and Itauma I., 2017: Is the secret to longevity eating chocolate? HPCC Systems Engineering Summit - Community Day.

Itauma I. and Chen X., 2016: Unsupervised Learning and Image Classification in High Performance Computing Cluster. HPCC Systems Engineering Summit Community Day (Poster Presentation & Speaker).

Itauma I., Bubba T., 2016: Academic Success Centers: Improving Resource Utilization using Grounded Theory Methodology. The 15th Annual South Florida Education Research Conference, June 4. Miami, Florida, USA.

Itauma I., Aslan M.S, Villanustre F., and Chen X., 2015: Unsupervised Learning and Image Classification in High Performance Computing Cluster. 14th International Conference on Machine Learning and Applications (IEEE ICMLA'15), December 9-11. Miami, Florida, USA.

Books & Scholarly Contributions

Itauma I., 2024. Machine Learning Using Python. Quarto Publishing.

Itauma I., Aslan M. S., Chen X. W., Villanustre F., 2016: Unsupervised Learning and Image Classification in High Performance Computing Cluster. Big Data Technologies and Applications, pp.387-400, Springer International (Book Chapter).

Awards & Recognitions

- Learning Analytics in STEM Education Research (LASER) Scholar, funded by the National Science Foundation — 2023
- Certificate of Appreciation, Northwood University — 2023
- Harvard Business Analytics Program Certificate of Excellence — 2020
- HPCC Systems Community Innovator — 2015-2020
- Best Reviewer, CS Student Workshop, Istanbul — 2011
- Bilateral Education Scholarship, Nigerian Govt. — 2007–2012

Languages

English (*Native*), Turkish (*Highly proficient*), German (*Proficient*)